

Acme Coffee Roasters — Customer Service Handbook

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1. About Acme Coffee Roasters

Acme Coffee Roasters is a specialty coffee company based in Cape Town, South Africa, with a roastery in Woodstock and retail locations in Sea Point and Stellenbosch. We source single-origin green coffee from smallholder farms in Ethiopia, Kenya, Rwanda, and Burundi, and roast in small batches three times a week. Our wholesale customers include independent cafés across the Western Cape and Gauteng provinces.

This handbook is the authoritative reference for our customer service team. It is also the document our AI customer service agent draws from when answering customer questions. If any information here is incorrect or updated, customers will receive incorrect answers. Please flag errors to operations@acmecoffee.example.

2. Our Coffee Range

We offer three core product lines: Single Origin, Signature Blends, and Decaffeinated. All beans are roasted to order and shipped within 48 hours of roasting. Whole bean is the default; we grind to order on request and recommend whole bean for freshness.

2.1 Single Origin

Our Single Origin range rotates seasonally based on harvest cycles. Current offerings include Yirgacheffe (Ethiopia), Nyeri AA (Kenya), and Mibirizi (Rwanda). Each origin is sold as 250g and 1kg bags. Tasting notes, altitude, and processing method are printed on each bag and listed on our website.

2.2 Signature Blends

We offer four house blends year-round: Table Mountain Espresso (our flagship), Cape Point Filter, Karoo Decaf, and Winelands Espresso. Blends are formulated to maintain consistent flavour profiles even as individual component origins rotate. The Table Mountain Espresso has been our best-seller since 2019 and accounts for roughly 40 percent of our retail volume.

2.3 Decaffeinated

Our Karoo Decaf is processed using the Swiss Water Method, which uses no chemical solvents. It is suitable for customers avoiding caffeine for medical or personal reasons. The Swiss Water Method removes approximately 99.9 percent of caffeine from the green beans before roasting.

3. Wholesale Pricing

Prices below are per kilogram, excluding VAT, for wholesale accounts. Minimum order quantities apply. All prices are in South African Rand and are valid through 30 June 2026. Retail pricing differs and is available on the public website.

Product	Grade	MOQ (kg)	Price (R/kg)	Lead Time
Yirgacheffe	Single Origin	5	R 480	3-5 days
Nyeri AA	Single Origin	5	R 520	3-5 days
Mibirizi	Single Origin	5	R 460	3-5 days
Table Mountain Espresso	Signature Blend	10	R 380	2-3 days
Cape Point Filter	Signature Blend	10	R 360	2-3 days
Winelands Espresso	Signature Blend	10	R 395	2-3 days
Karoo Decaf	Decaffeinated	5	R 440	5-7 days

Wholesale accounts must complete a credit application before their first order. Approved accounts receive 30-day payment terms. New accounts pay on order for the first three months.

4. Shipping and Delivery

We ship nationally within South Africa via The Courier Guy for orders under 20kg and via Aramex for larger consignments. Deliveries to major metros (Cape Town, Johannesburg, Pretoria, Durban) typically arrive within 2-3 business days of dispatch. Outlying areas may take 5-7 days.

We do not currently ship internationally. Customers outside South Africa should contact our wholesale team to discuss freight forwarding options.

Shipping is free for retail orders above R 750 and for all wholesale orders meeting the minimum order quantity. Below those thresholds, shipping is calculated at checkout based on weight and destination.

5. Returns and Refunds

We stand behind every bag we roast. If you are unhappy with your coffee for any reason, contact us within 14 days of delivery and we will replace the product or refund your purchase.

5.1 What We Replace

We replace coffee that has been damaged in transit, was incorrectly fulfilled (wrong product, wrong grind, wrong quantity), or arrived past its roast-date freshness window of six weeks. Photographic evidence of damage is required for transit claims.

5.2 What We Refund

We issue refunds for unopened bags returned within 14 days, for subscription cancellations processed before the next billing cycle, and for wholesale orders cancelled before dispatch. Refunds are issued to the original payment method within 5 business days of receipt.

5.3 What We Do Not Replace or Refund

We do not replace or refund coffee that has been opened and partially consumed unless there is a verifiable quality defect. Personal taste preferences are not grounds for refund — we encourage customers unsure of their preferences to order our Discovery Sample Pack first.

6. Subscriptions

Acme Subscriptions ship every two or four weeks. Subscribers receive a 10 percent discount on retail pricing and free shipping on every order regardless of value. Subscribers can pause, skip, or cancel at any time through their account dashboard. Cancellations made at least 48 hours before the next billing date take effect immediately; later cancellations take effect from the cycle after next.

The Roaster's Choice subscription is our most popular tier. Each shipment includes a 250g bag of a Single Origin selected by our head roaster, with tasting notes and brewing recommendations. Roaster's Choice is the best way for new customers to explore the range.

7. Wholesale Accounts

Wholesale accounts are available to cafés, restaurants, offices, and retail stockists. Application is via the wholesale form on our website. Approved accounts receive trade pricing, dedicated account management,

training resources, and equipment service referrals to our partner technicians.

We provide barista training at no charge for accounts ordering more than 20kg per month. Training is delivered at our Woodstock roastery and covers extraction theory, milk technique, calibration, and basic machine maintenance. Two training slots are reserved per quarter for each qualifying account.

8. Contact and Escalation

Retail customer enquiries: hello@acmecoffee.example. Response time during business hours is typically under 4 hours. Wholesale account enquiries: wholesale@acmecoffee.example. Urgent operational issues (missed deliveries, machine failures at training-tier accounts): 021 555 0143 during business hours, 082 555 0143 after hours.

Customer service agents should escalate to a human team member when: a customer asks about an order placed more than 60 days ago, a refund request exceeds R 2000, a wholesale account requests credit terms or pricing changes, or a customer expresses dissatisfaction in language suggesting they may leave a public review.